



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 18- Forms and Stages of Public Speaking Part-1

Prof. Binod Mishra

DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



Oral Tradition

- ❑ Oral tradition has been the most archaic mode of human communication.
- ❑ It is dynamic in nature.
- ❑ It is an extremely diverse oral-aural medium for transmitting thoughts, ideas, culture, art, narratives, and legacies.
- ❑ It is one of the earliest modes of public speaking.



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Public Speaking and Stage



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- ❑ Be it for entertainment or persuasion, public speaking has been locomotive in bringing change since its inception.
- ❑ In ancient times, there were amphitheaters (as shown in the picture beside) where people would gather for everything- performances, speeches, information, etc.

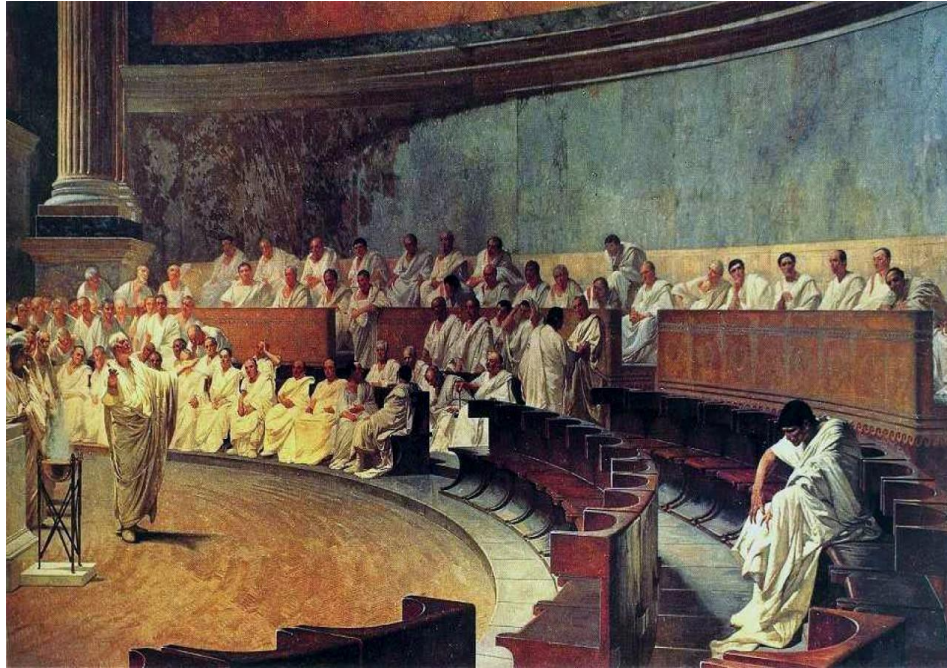
Genesis of Public Speaking in Greece

- ❑ The known facts depict that Greek society greatly relied on oral expressions.
- ❑ They delivered epideictic (to praise or blame someone) speeches.
- ❑ They extensively practised rhetoric.
- ❑ They constantly evolved their governing structures with the use of public speaking.



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Genesis of Public Speaking in Rome



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- Oratory was treated as an elementary skill and was taught to every boy in Rome.
- Roman citizens were mostly expected to speak in public in their life span. Either they opined, or they took part in meetings, but almost everybody spoke in a public gathering.

Shruti Tradition in India

- Oral tradition has existed in the Indian subcontinent since time immemorial.
- Shruti Parampara (learning through hearing) flourished in cultural, spiritual, and social life.
- The ancient Tamil classic, Thiruvalluvar's *Kural*, contains two chapters on the virtues of good speech.



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Indic Knowledge Tradition

- ❑ Shruti and Smriti Literatures
- ❑ The Vedas and The Upanishads
- ❑ Vedic Mantras are *nitya*(Eternal and *apauresheya*, not created by humans)

Shushrut
Pythagorean
theorem
Algorithm
Panini

Contd...

In chapter two of *Kural* titled “Power in Speech,” Thiruvalluvar writes,

“A tongue that rightly speaks the right is greatest gain,
It stands alone midst goodly things that men obtain.”

The possession of that goodness which is called the goodness of speech is (even to others) better than any other goodness.

“Since gain and loss in life on speech depend,
From careless slip in speech thyself defend.”

Since (both) wealth and evil result from (their) speech, ministers should most carefully guard themselves against faultiness therein.

(Pope et al.)

Continued...

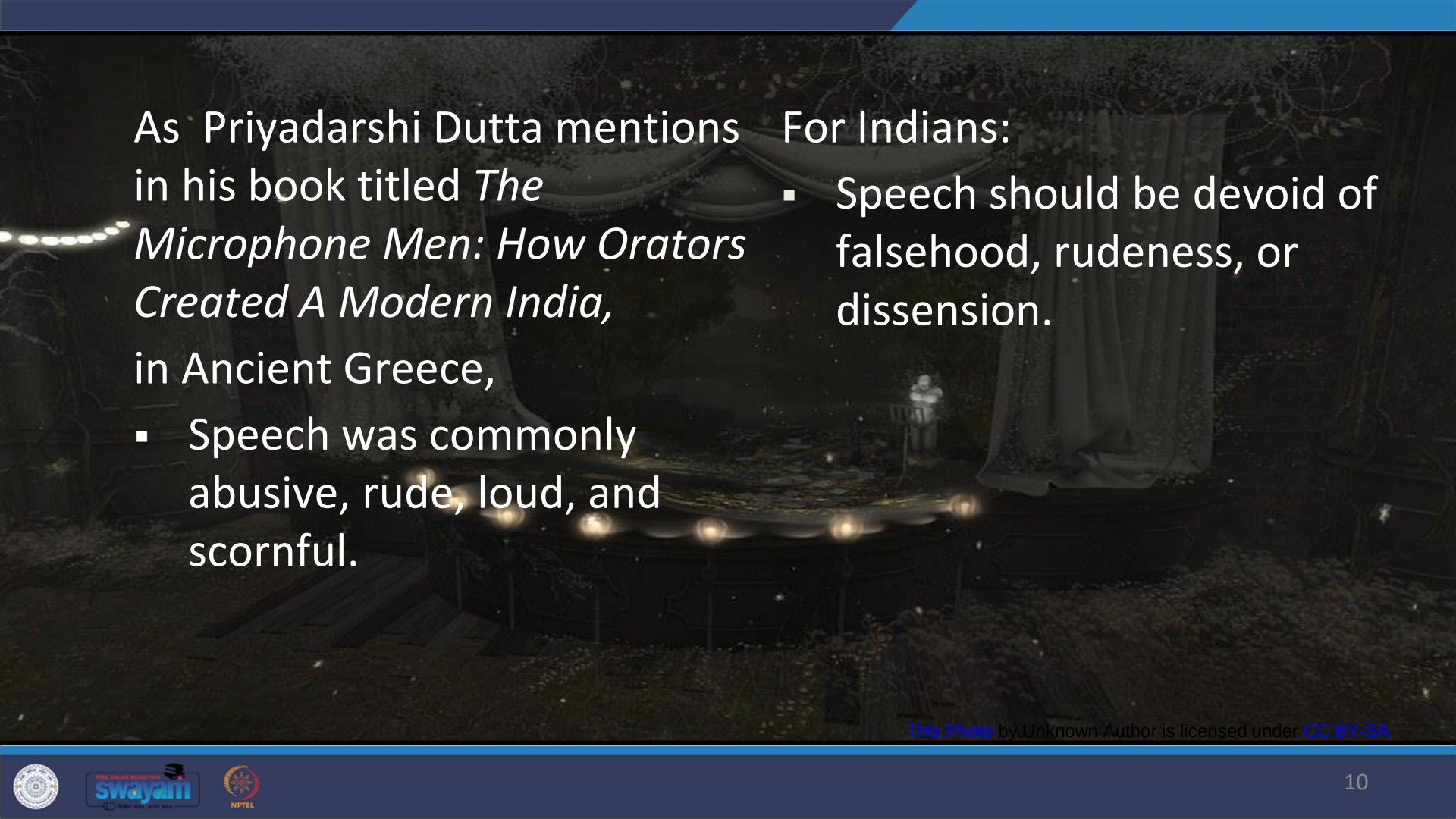
“’Tis speech that spell-bound holds the listening ear,
While those who have not heard desire to hear.”

The (minister's) speech is that which seeks (to express) elements as bind his friends (to himself) and is so delivered as to make even his enemies desire (his friendship).

“Speak words adapted well to various hearers' state;
No higher virtue lives, no gain more surely great.”

Understand the qualities (of your hearers) and (then) make your speech; for superior to it, there is neither virtue nor wealth.

(Pope et al.)



As Priyadarshi Dutta mentions in his book titled *The Microphone Men: How Orators Created A Modern India*, in Ancient Greece,

- Speech was commonly abusive, rude, loud, and scornful.

For Indians:

- Speech should be devoid of falsehood, rudeness, or dissension.

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Public Speaking and Politics

- ❑ As expressed by Israeli politician Yitzhak Shamir, “the will of people is resolved by a strong leadership. Even in a democratic society, events depend on a strong leadership with a strong power of persuasion, and not on the opinion of the masses.”
- ❑ Public Speaking has been the driving force for many rulers, politicians, monarchs like Solon, Hitler, Mussolini, Indira Gandhi, Obama, Modi, so on and so forth.
- ❑ There are several popular political speeches that are still heard and oft quoted.

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Cassius' Speech in *Julius Caesar*

"Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world
Like a Colossus, and we petty men
Walk under his huge legs and peep about
To find ourselves dishonourable graves.
Men at some time are masters of their fates:
The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars,
But in ourselves, that we are underlings.
Brutus and Caesar: what should be in that 'Caesar'?
Why should that name be sounded more than yours?
Write them together, yours is as fair a name;
Sound them, it doth become the mouth as well;
Weigh them, it is as heavy; conjure with 'em,
Brutus will start a spirit as soon as Caesar.

Now, in the names of all the gods at once,
Upon what meat doth this our Caesar feed
That he is grown so great? Age, thou art shamed!
Rome, thou hast lost the breed of noble bloods!" (I,ii,135-151)

Popular Political Speeches

"Long years ago we made a tryst with destiny, and now the time comes when we shall redeem our pledge, not wholly or in full measure, but very substantially. At the stroke of the midnight hour, when the world sleeps, India will awake to life and freedom. A moment comes, which comes but rarely in history, when we step out from the old to new, when an age ends, and when the soul of a nation, long suppressed, finds utterance..."



I have a
Dream by
**Martin Luther
King, Jr.**



I have a dream that one day this nation will rise up and live out the true meaning of its creed: "We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal."

I have a dream that one day on the red hills of Georgia, the sons of former slaves and the sons of former slave owners will be able to sit down together at the table of brotherhood.

Women's
Rights Are
Human Rights
by **Hillary
Clinton**

If there is one message that echoes forth from this conference, it is that human rights are women's rights - and women's rights are human rights. Let us not forget that among those rights are the right to speak freely - and the right to be heard. Women must enjoy the right to participate fully in the social and political lives of their countries if we want freedom and democracy to thrive and endure.



Tryst with
Destiny by
**Jawaharlal
Nehru**

Spreading Awareness through Public Speaking

- ❑ Public speaking has always been a mode of communicating awareness to a greater audience. With its tools of persuasion and effective communication, one can spread important messages, amplify social awareness. There are several initiatives all over the globe that have been diligent in creating mass awareness.



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Public Speaking and Literature

- ❑ Dramas
 - ✓ A rich mode of performance in Public Speaking
 - ✓ A medium enabling speakers to put stories into action
 - ✓ Teachings of ancient heroes helpful in creating awareness and distinguishing good from evil
- ❑ In Europe and Greece, dramas had a religious origin.
- ❑ Characters were drawn from the *New Testament*.

Vernacular Plays in European Middle Ages

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graph TD; A[Vernacular Plays in European Middle Ages] --- B[Miracle Plays]; A --- C[Mystery Plays]; A --- D[Morality Plays];
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Miracle Plays

Mystery Plays

Morality Plays

Miracle Plays

- ❑ Depicted martyrdom of saint
- ❑ It could be either a real or fictional account
- ❑ Developed in the 10th and 11th century
- ❑ By the 13th century, it comprised unecclesiastical elements as well



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Mystery Plays

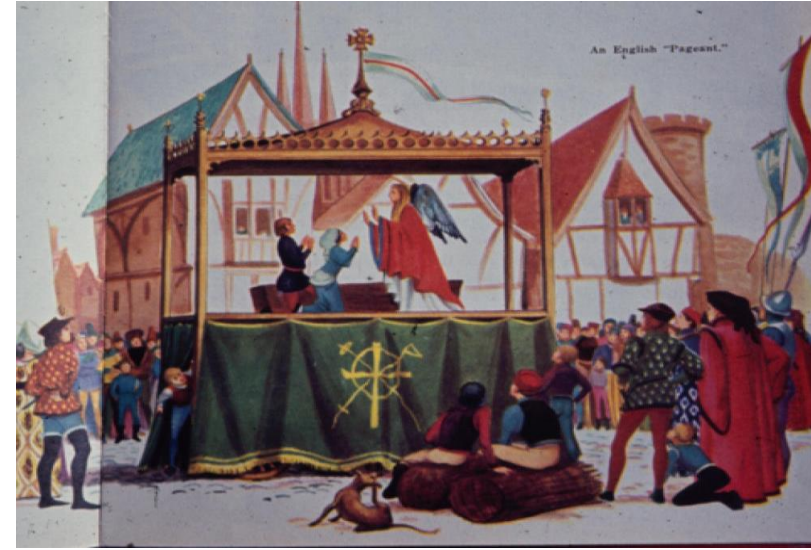
- ❑ Mystery(*mystere*)- scenes from the life of Christ or stories from the *Old Testament* , *Man's creation, Fall and Redemption*
- ❑ It sprung from the Latin plays by Churchmen in the 10th century
- ❑ Represented Biblical subjects
- ❑ It took four centuries for development
- ❑ Started first in churches, later in churchyards
- ❑ Mounted on a wagon with a curtained scaffolding

Ludus de Sancta
Katharina
(earliest Miracle
in England,
1110)
*Miracles de
Notre Dame*



Morality play

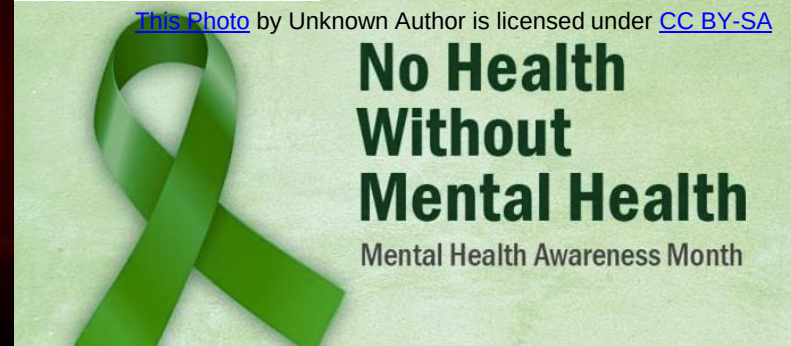
- ❑ Allegorical drama popular in 15th and 16th century Europe
- ❑ Allegory in dramatic form, origin in sermon literature
- ❑ Abstract human qualities
- ❑ End in the triumph of virtue
- ❑ *Everyman* –The most talked of morality play
- ❑ It depicts the summoning of every man by Death
- ❑ It was somewhere between the transition from liturgical drama and secular professional drama



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Life
Death
Repentance
Goodness
Love
Greed
Other Virtues and
Vices

Some of the initiatives:



Public Speaking and Religion

- Every established religion today exists because of the way its preachers addressed and influenced the minds of the masses.
- Be it Prophet or Jesus, Guru Nanak or Buddha- all of them delivered sermons (a form of public speaking) which later were documented and became the holy scriptures of the religion that they propagated.





Buddha's first sermon

“The Noble Truth of suffering (Dukkha) is this: Birth is suffering; aging is suffering; sickness is suffering; death is suffering; sorrow and lamentation, pain, grief, and despair are suffering; association with the unpleasant is suffering; dissociation from the pleasant is suffering; not to get what one wants is suffering – in brief, the five aggregates of attachment are suffering.” (Rahula)

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Excerpt from Gita

इन्द्रियाणि मनो बुद्धिरस्याधिष्ठानमुच्यते ।
एतैर्विमोहयत्येष ज्ञानमावृत्य देहिनम् ॥ ४० ॥

Translation: (Lord Shri Krishna in these lines tells Arjuna about desire.)
Our senses, mind and intellect act as the breeding ground for desire.
They cloud one's knowledge and delude the embodied soul.

“God, that all-powerful Creator of nature and architect of the world, has impressed man with no character so proper to distinguish him from other animals, as by the faculty of speech.”

~ QUINTILIAN

Thank You

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